This is not an exhaustive assessment of India's and China's soft power. For instance, the extent of public and cultural diplomacy (including training foreign officials and workers), humanitarian and development assistance (including peacekeeping, aid), and infrastructure and connectivity projects abroad matter as well. In cultural influence, the reputation of one's classical and modern art, one's cuisine, music, and films, and one's popular cultural products have an impact on foreigners. In modern mass societies, sports achievements too have a huge impact. In terms of political influence, respect for political diversity, rights, and tolerance also attract or repulse others. These other elements are only very partially measured by the Lowy assessment. Most importantly, though, the Lowy study only gives us a comparison of soft power *resources*. To get a more convincing estimate of soft power *outcomes* would require getting into people's heads by means of surveys and polls to establish whether India's and China's foreign policies, their cultural products, and their political values actually do attract or repulse. In any case, what can we say about their soft power beyond the numbers?

Soft Power Beyond the Numbers

Having said that the Lowy figures and numeric comparisons have their limitations, a broad conclusion is that India is behind in terms of its perceived international diplomatic and cultural attraction but does better, by some distance, on political attraction (openness or 'voice and accountability'). Even here, we should be careful, for at least two contradictory reasons. First, in the eyes of many around the world, India's political openness is the problem and not the solution. John Kenneth Galbraith, the US ambassador to India during the 1962 India–China war, in a backhanded compliment remarked that India is a 'functioning anarchy'. For many in Southeast and Northeast Asia, India's openness is anarchy, plain and simple. They see little that is functional. After a decade of living and working in East Asia, I have yet to hear a fulsome endorsement of